

UNIT
54

MEETING FLOW

CONVERSATION

Ethan: Jessica, I've never led a meeting before. This will be my first time as the chairperson. Can you walk me through how it usually goes?

Jessica: Sure! First, you set up the agenda, which is basically a list of what you're going to cover.

Ethan: Got it. Then what happens?

Jessica: Next, attendees arrive, and you kick things off as the chairperson.

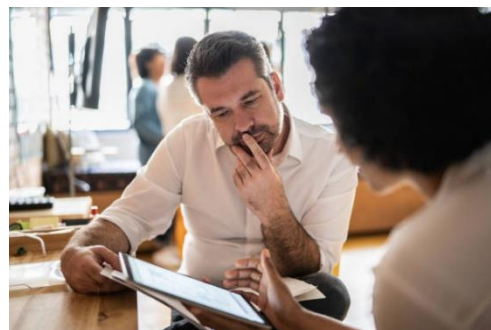
Ethan: Okay... and during the meeting?

Jessica: After that, there's some deliberation, where everyone talks things through carefully. Then you reach a conclusion, which is like the bottom line of the discussion. Next, you go over the action items, assigning tasks based on the decisions made.

Ethan: I'm following.

Jessica: Finally, you give a summary of the key points discussed. After the meeting, you prepare the minutes — the written record of what happened. Then the follow-up happens, checking that the action items are done and everything agreed upon is completed.

Ethan: Perfect, that really helps! Thanks, Jessica!



VOCABULARY

Meeting Agenda	
Date: Feb 22, 2024	Time: 9:00 am Location: Room 42
Topic 1: Title of First Topic	
• Discussion point list with bullets • Second talking point • Third talking point	
Topic 2: Title of Second Topic	
1. Discussion point list with numbers 2. Second talking point 3. Third talking point	
Topic 3: Title of Third Topic	
A. Discussion point list with letters B. Second talking point C. Third talking point	
Topic 4: Title of Fourth Topic	
I. Discussion point with roman numerals II. Second talking point III. Third talking point	



Agenda

Attendees

Chairperson

Deliberation



Follow-up



Action plan



Summary

Minutes	
Meeting title: Event Planning Meeting	Date + Time: November 15, 2023, 10:00 AM Location: Conference Room A, 3rd floor
Attendees:	Agenda:
John Smith, Director of Marketing Maria Garcia, Director of Finance Sophie Wilson, Associate	Agenda Item 1: What should our primary objective for this year? • The title should display and reinforce our expertise in the field. • It should maintain accurate brand representation.
Absentees:	Action Items:
Jane White, Assistant	Item 1: • Stephen Wilson will oversee the brainstorming and should drive the timeline for the next meeting.
Decisions:	Item 2: • Jessica Taylor and Jane White will perform outreach to confirm meeting guest speakers' availability and secure one additional guest speaker.
Item 1: • Examples for brainstorming this idea to the marketing team.	
Item 2: • Maximize last year's guest speaker list and secure one additional guest speaker.	
Next Meeting Date: October 21	

Minutes

LANGUAGE PRACTICE

Sequencers

So what do we do **first** in the meeting?

First, we go over the agenda

Then do we start the discussion?

Yeah. **After that**, we take notes on decisions, and **next**, we review the action items.

Finally, we summarize the key points and thank everyone for joining.



MEETING FLOW

EXERCISE 1

Complete each sentence with the correct meeting vocabulary word (agenda, attendees, chairperson, deliberation, follow-up, action items, summary, minutes).

- A. During the discussion, there is careful _____ to talk through important issues.
- B. Before the meeting, the _____ is prepared to list the topics to discuss.
- C. After the meeting, a _____ is done to check that all tasks are completed.
- D. All the _____ arrived on time to participate in the discussion.
- E. After reaching decisions, the team reviews the _____ to assign tasks.
- F. The _____ gives a brief overview of the key points discussed.
- G. After the meeting, the _____ is written to record what happened.
- H. The _____ is responsible for leading and guiding the meeting.

EXERCISE 2

Complete the text below with a sequencer (First, Next, After that, Then, Finally). More than one option is possible in some cases.

- A. _____, the chairperson prepares the agenda to organize the topics for discussion.
- B. _____, all the attendees arrive and settle in for the meeting.
- C. _____, the meeting begins, and participants engage in deliberation to discuss key issues.
- D. _____, the group goes over the action items that need to be done.
- E. _____, a summary is given of the main points, the minutes are written, and any follow-up is planned.

SUMMARY

Sequencer	Use / Meaning	Example
First	Introduces the first step in a process	First, the chairperson prepares the agenda.
Next / Then / After that	Shows the step that comes after the previous one	Next, the attendees arrive. / Then, the group discusses action items. / After that, the meeting continues with deliberation.
Finally	Indicates the last step	Finally, a summary is given and the minutes are written.

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. deliberation
- B. agenda
- C. follow-up
- D. attendees
- E. action items
- F. summary
- G. minutes
- H. chairperson

Exercise 2

- A. First
- B. Next / Then / After that
- C. Next / Then / After that
- D. Next / Then / After that
- E. Finally